

Daily inspiration report, 2026-10-09

1. Summary

- This run could not open Facebook or Social Blade at all (blocked without a login), and search showed no follower snippets. So there are no competitor Reel links or view counts today. Follower numbers below come from third-party lists and are marked.
- Our page: 6 Reels went out within 4 minutes (01:20 to 01:24 UTC on Oct 9, the evening of Oct 8 in the US). Two of them got 717 of the 722 plays. Two got 0.
- News niche: photo plus headline is the winning format for big publishers (17 of the 20 best NYT and Fox posts in early 2025 were photos, per Nieman Lab / NewsWhip). Animal and rescue stories took the top 2 spots across 50 publishers in Q3 2025.
- New niches: faith and prayer scored best (6.4), then pets (6.0), then nostalgia (5.4). All close, none an easy win, evidence thin.
- Meta reduces reach and pay for pages that reuse other people's content or use long unrelated captions (July 2025 policy, TechCrunch). Staying original is a requirement, not a nicety.

What could not be done: Facebook pages, Social Blade and most CreatorDB pages did not open for this job, and search results came back without follower snippets. So 'posts per day', caption style, video length, music and visual style are

unknown for every competitor page, and no motivation Reel could be found with a public link. The motivation list is candidates by name only, not a ranking. To fix this the scan needs either a list of competitor page and Reel links pasted by Adin, or a browser that can render Facebook logged out.

2. Top pages: motivation quotes

Candidates by name only. Not a ranking. Posts per day, formats and style are unknown for all of them.

Power of Positivity

- **Followers:** FB unknown; owner claims 50M+ across all platforms (podcast page, Feb 2024)
- **Themes:** positivity, self-improvement (from name and site)
- **Formats:** unknown
- **Posts per day:** unknown
- **Monetization signals:** own website and books; FB payouts unknown (low)
- **Link:** <https://www.facebook.com/powerofpositivity/>

Lessons Learned In Life

- **Followers:** unknown
- **Themes:** life-lesson quotes (from name)
- **Formats:** unknown
- **Posts per day:** unknown
- **Monetization signals:** unknown (low)
- **Link:** <https://www.facebook.com/lessonslearnedinlife/>

Lessons Learned In Life Quotes

- **Followers:** unknown

- **Themes:** unknown; may be a sister or copycat page
- **Formats:** unknown
- **Posts per day:** unknown
- **Monetization signals:** unknown (low)
- **Link:**
<https://www.facebook.com/LessonsLearnedInLifeQuotes/>

Tiny Buddha

- **Followers:** unknown
- **Themes:** wisdom, life lessons (from site)
- **Formats:** unknown
- **Posts per day:** unknown
- **Monetization signals:** own site and books; FB payouts unknown (low)
- **Link:** <https://www.facebook.com/tinybuddha/>

Positive & Inspirational Quotes

- **Followers:** unknown
- **Themes:** quotes (name only)
- **Formats:** unknown
- **Posts per day:** unknown
- **Monetization signals:** unknown (low)
- **Link:** <https://www.facebook.com/Positiveandinspirationalquotes/>

Inspiring and Positive Quotes

- **Followers:** unknown
- **Themes:** quotes (name only)
- **Formats:** unknown
- **Posts per day:** unknown
- **Monetization signals:** unknown (low)
- **Link:** <https://www.facebook.com/InspiringandPositive/>

Motivational Quotes

- **Followers:** unknown
- **Themes:** quotes (name only)
- **Formats:** unknown
- **Posts per day:** unknown
- **Monetization signals:** unknown (low)
- **Link:** <https://www.facebook.com/motivationalquotes/>

A Beautiful Mess Inside

- **Followers:** 696K+ (Calmsage list, updated 2025, not checked)
- **Themes:** unknown
- **Formats:** unknown
- **Posts per day:** unknown
- **Monetization signals:** unknown (low)

- **Link:** <https://www.facebook.com/abeautifulmessinside>

Believe And Create

- **Followers:** 157K+ (Calmsage list, updated 2025, not checked)
- **Themes:** unknown
- **Formats:** unknown
- **Posts per day:** unknown
- **Monetization signals:** unknown (low)
- **Link:**
<https://www.facebook.com/believeandcreatecommunity/>

2. Top pages: news and good news

Upworthy

- **Followers:** 10.1M (Feedspot, Jul 2026)
- **Themes:** kindness, human interest, questions that invite comments
- **Formats:** unknown
- **Posts per day:** unknown
- **Monetization signals:** own website; no FB signal seen (low)
- **Link:** <https://www.facebook.com/Upworthy/>

TODAY (good news section)

- **Followers:** 8.6M, parent TODAY page (Feedspot)
- **Themes:** mainstream feel-good, family, celebrity
- **Formats:** unknown
- **Posts per day:** unknown
- **Monetization signals:** big broadcaster; nothing specific seen (low)
- **Link:** unknown

Good News Network

- **Followers:** 607.5K (Feedspot); 600,000+ (Boston Globe, Jan 2025)
- **Themes:** animals, rescues, science, inspiring people

- **Formats:** FB unknown; likely link and photo posts to its site (inference)
- **Posts per day:** FB unknown; website 3 to 4 stories a day (Oct 7 to 8)
- **Monetization signals:** site ads, \$2/month ad-free membership, shop, app (high for site, low for FB payouts)
- **Link:** <https://www.facebook.com/thegoodnewsnetwork/>

DailyGood

- **Followers:** 442.6K (Feedspot)
- **Themes:** one uplifting story a day
- **Formats:** unknown
- **Posts per day:** about 1 (site description)
- **Monetization signals:** unknown (low)
- **Link:** unknown

WFMZ-TV 69News

- **Followers:** 300.5K (Feedspot)
- **Themes:** Pennsylvania local news plus a good-news segment
- **Formats:** unknown
- **Posts per day:** unknown
- **Monetization signals:** local TV site ads (low)
- **Link:** unknown

Sunny Skyz

- **Followers:** 288.8K (Feedspot)
- **Themes:** stranger kindness, animal rescue, kids, elderly
- **Formats:** unknown
- **Posts per day:** FB unknown; website about 1 story a day (Sep 2026)
- **Monetization signals:** own website (low)
- **Link:** <https://www.facebook.com/SunnySkyzOnline/>

Good Black News

- **Followers:** 99.4K (Feedspot)
- **Themes:** positive Black community news
- **Formats:** unknown
- **Posts per day:** unknown
- **Monetization signals:** unknown (low)
- **Link:** unknown

Good News Movement

- **Followers:** FB unknown; Instagram 5.52M (CreatorDB, Oct 3 2026)
- **Themes:** animal clips, community fundraisers, elderly, mentoring
- **Formats:** native videos on FB; rest unknown

- **Posts per day:** FB unknown; Instagram 7 posts a week (CreatorDB)
- **Monetization signals:** brand partnerships, ad packages, book, speaking (high for brand deals, low for FB payouts)
- **Link:** <https://www.facebook.com/goodnewsmovement/>

Tank's Good News

- **Followers:** unknown
- **Themes:** headline screenshots of good news, with humor (press description)
- **Formats:** unknown
- **Posts per day:** unknown
- **Monetization signals:** podcast; nothing else verified (low)
- **Link:** <https://www.facebook.com/tanksgoodnews/>

CBS News

- **Followers:** unknown
- **Themes:** politics plus animal, rescue and reunion video
- **Formats:** 88% of its top 1,000 posts were video (NewsWhip, Q2 2025)
- **Posts per day:** unknown
- **Monetization signals:** native video at scale suggests in-video ads; not confirmed (low)
- **Link:** <https://www.facebook.com/CBSNews/>

Fox News

- **Followers:** unknown
- **Themes:** politics, major events, birthdays, deaths
- **Formats:** top posts almost all photos; links 51% of output (NewsWhip, Q2 2025)
- **Posts per day:** unknown; posts less often than most peers (NewsWhip)
- **Monetization signals:** link posts send traffic to its site (medium for site ads, low for FB payouts)
- **Link:** <https://www.facebook.com/FoxNews/>

3. Top Reels and posts

Motivation: none found with a public link today.

News (2025 data; engagement, not views):

CBS News

- **Numbers:** 1.2M+ engagements, top post of Q3 2025 (NewsWhip); views unknown
- **Hook, in our words:** A bear and her cubs raid the food in a man's truck in Tennessee
- **Footage:** bystander wildlife video
- **Link:** <https://www.facebook.com/CBSNews/videos/1347943573567942/>

ABC News

- **Numbers:** 884K engagements, Q3 2025 (NewsWhip); views unknown
- **Hook, in our words:** Two men pull a stranded monkey out of a river
- **Footage:** eyewitness rescue video
- **Link:** <https://www.facebook.com/ABCNews/videos/1260994352228507/>

Fox News

- **Numbers:** in the Q3 2025 top 10 (NewsWhip); numbers unknown

- **Hook, in our words:** Either a grieving relative of a Texas flood victim or a speech about school prayer; the source does not say which link is which
- **Footage:** video
- **Link:** <https://www.facebook.com/FoxNews/videos/698366109929716/>

Fox News

- **Numbers:** in the Q3 2025 top 10 (NewsWhip); numbers unknown
- **Hook, in our words:** The other of those two Fox items
- **Footage:** post, probably a photo (not confirmed)
- **Link:** <https://www.facebook.com/FoxNews/posts/pfbid0KS47WP1NS7axB9fSGHq3aGxcTL5Djwc3jZqkAuhwW9Xu bqrrW7EafK2ZkX7AfA2kl>

The Guardian (UK, format reference only)

- **Numbers:** 214K+ engagements, Q3 2025 (NewsWhip)
- **Hook, in our words:** A famous killer is refused parole yet again
- **Footage:** strong photo plus the story headline
- **Link:** <https://www.facebook.com/100064447883826/posts/1196499035841681/>

Length, music, text style and caption style are unknown for all five: none could be opened. They are about a year old. CBS proxy from NewsWhip: median top video 54 seconds;

clips under 30 seconds had the highest average engagement.

4. Our numbers

Unpopular Truths

- Followers: 7 (4 this morning).
- Latest batch: 6 Reels, published Oct 9 01:20 to 01:24 UTC (Oct 8, about 9:20 PM US Eastern). Nothing was published on Oct 8 UTC.
- Plays on that batch: 722 in total, read about 16 hours after posting.
- Best: 'what helps on the hard days', 579 plays, 19 reactions, 3 shares, 3.8 s average watch.
<https://www.facebook.com/reel/1461936532477388/>
- Second: 'someone who just listens', 138 plays, 3 likes, 6.8 s average watch.
<https://www.facebook.com/reel/1118164580743997/>
- Worst: 'little things you would miss' and 'who makes a house a home', 0 plays each.
<https://www.facebook.com/reel/2115612295728882/>
- The other two: 3 plays and 2 plays.
- Comments on all Reels: 0.
- Oct 7 batch (3 Reels): 0 plays each. Oct 6 batch (3 Reels): 570, 361 and 258 plays.
- Queued: 5 Reels, Oct 09 18:00 UTC to Oct 10 03:00 UTC, 2 to 3 hours apart.

- Reach (unique people) is not available: the Facebook metric returns an error.

The 50 State Wire

- Followers: 0.
- Published posts yesterday: unknown. The post list cannot be read (Facebook says the 'pages_read_user_content' permission is missing), so there is no best or worst post.
- Page post engagements: 0. Page video views: 0. Reach: not available (metric error).
- Queued: 6 photo posts, Oct 09 18:00 UTC to Oct 10 01:30 UTC, 90 minutes apart.

5. New niches explored

Faith and prayer: 6.4 / 10

- **Scores:** audience 9, engagement 8, ease 8, competition 3, monetization 4 (low confidence)
- **Verdict:** Best fit for our tools, but slow growth and weak pay per view likely. Avoid 'type Amen' bait and AI Jesus images.
- **Formula:** One King James verse over a stock nature clip with soft licensed music, plus a two-sentence reflection of our own.

Pets and animal rescue: 6.0 / 10

- **Scores:** audience 9, engagement 9, ease 3, competition 3, monetization 6 (medium confidence)
- **Verdict:** Huge audience, but rescue stories need real footage; fake-rescue and AI scam pages are being called out. Only a pet-facts page is doable.
- **Formula:** Licensed stock pet clip, one checked breed or behavior fact as on-screen text, light music, no rescue claims, no donation asks.

Nostalgia (50s to 90s America): 5.4 / 10

- **Scores:** audience 6, engagement 7, ease 4, competition 4, monetization 6 (low confidence)
- **Verdict:** What works is copyrighted photos of toys, TV and stars. Enter only with public-domain sources;

otherwise skip.

- **Formula:** One public-domain archive photo or clip (Library of Congress, National Archives), an era-style licensed track, and a short 'who remembers this?' question.

Pages seen: The Ultimate '80s Page (about 2.7M, Bored Panda, about 2023), Do You Remember?; The Dodo (38M+ across pages, 2018 figure), Hope For Paws; Jesus Daily (31M), Joyce Meyer Ministries (12M), Spiritual Inspiration (8.4M) per a 2026 roundup that does not say how it checked. None could be opened.

Running top 5

- 1. Faith and prayer (6.4)
- 2. Pets and animal rescue (6.0)
- 3. Nostalgia (50s to 90s America) (5.4)

Only 3 niches explored so far.

6. What to upgrade on Unpopular Truths

1. Spread Reels out instead of posting them minutes apart.

- **Evidence:** Our numbers: 6 Reels in 4 minutes, 2 took 717 of 722 plays, 2 got 0; the 3 Reels of Oct 7 total 0 plays.
- **Test:** The next 5 Reels are already scheduled 2 to 3 hours apart. Compare median plays per Reel for those days against Oct 7 to 9.

2. Make more 'hard days / hope' and 'the one who takes care of everyone' Reels.

- **Evidence:** Best three so far: hard days (579 plays, 19 reactions, 3 shares), love in a simple question (570), the carer deserves care (361, 8 reactions). The hard-days Reel is the only one with more than one share.
- **Test:** Give these two themes half of the slots for 5 days; judge by shares per 100 plays.

3. Make the first frame work for a stranger.

- **Evidence:** Meta report cited by Gyre: 41% of US feed views are from pages people do not follow. Our two biggest Reels are watched only 3.3 to 3.8 seconds on average.
- **Test:** Open half the Reels with a one-line personal moment that holds back the lesson; compare average watch time.

4. Keep each text block on screen 3 seconds or more, with fewer words.

- **Evidence:** Low-confidence vendor guide (Flowshorts), plus our short watch times.
- **Test:** Cut text to two short blocks on half the Reels; compare average watch time.

5. Add one quote-image photo post a day next to the Reels.

- **Evidence:** A finance page owner says about 70% of his posts are image posts with comment (self-reported, podcast). Socialinsider 2026: images 0.10% engagement vs Reels 0.13%. Meta now pays on photos and text too (Fortune).
- **Test:** One still image per day for 5 days; compare reach and reactions with the same day's Reels.

6. Remake winners after two weeks with new footage and new wording.

- **Evidence:** Same owner recycles about 10% of posts and says most posts are dead after 48 hours.
- **Test:** Remake the hard-days Reel in two weeks; compare with the original.

7. Try one US-morning slot (6 to 8 AM Eastern).

- **Evidence:** All our Reels so far went out between 3 and 9:30 PM Eastern. The only timing source is a low-confidence vendor guide (6 to 8 AM and 8 to 10 PM).

- **Test:** Move one Reel a day to the morning for 5 days; compare plays.

8. Keep captions short and everything original.

- **Evidence:** Meta's July 2025 rules cut reach and pay for reused content and for long unrelated captions (TechCrunch, Yahoo Tech).
- **Test:** No test needed; keep the current one-question caption.

Suggestions for The 50 State Wire

1. Lead with animal and rescue stories.

- **Evidence:** Top 2 posts across 50 publishers in Q3 2025 were a bear video and a monkey rescue (NewsWhip). A quarter of Sunny Skyz's most-viewed stories in Sep 2026 were animals.
- **Test:** One animal story a day; compare reactions per post.

2. Open the headline on the photo with an age, a number or a US place.

- **Evidence:** Pattern across this week's Good News Network and Sunny Skyz story lists.
- **Test:** Use it on half the posts; compare reach.

3. Favor US stories, and keep the source line.

- **Evidence:** The page promises 50 states, yet one queued post is about New Zealand. A McGill report (June 2026) found 340 pages posting made-up news in this format; visible sources set us apart.
- **Test:** Keep as a rule.

4. Do not raise volume; 6 a day is plenty.

- **Evidence:** NewsWhip found little or no link between how often publishers post and engagement; Good News Network runs 3 to 4 stories a day.
- **Test:** Hold volume; improve story choice.

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